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MySQL SELECT DISTINCT Statement

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The MySQL SELECT DISTINCT Statement

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The `SELECT DISTINCT` statement is used to return only distinct (unique) values.

In a table, a column may contain several duplicate values - and sometimes you want to list only the unique values.

The following SQL selects all the distinct (unique) country values from the "Customers" table:

Example

Get your own SQL Server

```
SELECT DISTINCT Country FROM Customers;
```

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SELECT DISTINCT Syntax

```
SELECT DISTINCT column1, column2, ...
FROM table_name;
```

Demo Database

Below is a selection from the "Customers" table in the Northwind sample database:

CustomerID	CustomerName	ContactName	Address	City	PostalCode	Co
1	Alfreds Futterkiste	Maria Anders	Obere Str. 57	Berlin	12209	Ge
2	Ana Trujillo Emparedados y helados	Ana Trujillo	Avda. de la Constitución 2222	México D.F.	05021	Me
3	Antonio Moreno Taquería	Antonio Moreno	Mataderos 2312	México D.F.	05023	Me
4	Around the Horn	Thomas Hardy	120 Hanover Sq.	London	WA1 1DP	UK
5	Berglunds snabbköp	Christina Berglund	Berguvsvägen 8	Luleå	S-958 22	Sw

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SELECT Example Without DISTINCT

If you omit the `DISTINCT` keyword, the SQL statement returns all the "Country" values from all the records of the "Customers" table:

Example

```
SELECT Country FROM Customers;
```

Try it Yourself »

Count Distinct Values

By using the `COUNT()` function with the `DISTINCT` keyword, we can count the number of unique values.

The following SQL counts the number of unique countries in the "Customers" table:

Example

You will learn more about the `COUNT()` function later in this tutorial.

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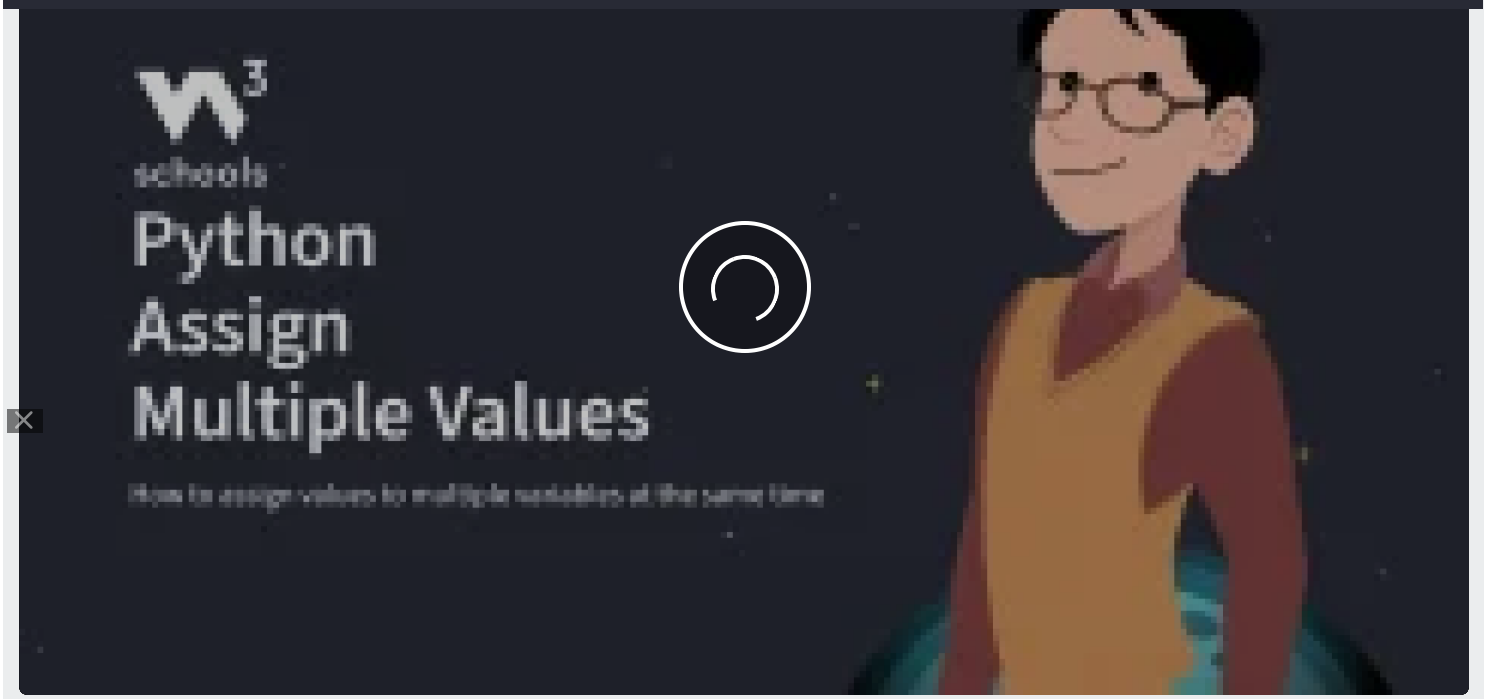
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